

MIKOMI

—— 日本語学院 ——

WHERE YOUR JAPANESE JOURNEY BEGINS

MIKOMI JAPANESE LANGUAGE INSTITUTE

Hiragana Practice Workbook

ひらがな れんしゅうちょう

JLPT N5 · ABSOLUTE BEGINNER

Prepared by **Mikomi Japanese Language Institute**

Founder — Astha Pokhriyal | JLPT N2 Certified | 6+ Years Teaching

Learn Japanese. Unlock Global Opportunities.

Start Here はじめに

Welcome to your very first step into Japanese! Hiragana is the heart of the language — master these 46 sounds and you can read and pronounce almost anything. Take your time, enjoy the practice, and remember: every expert was once a beginner.

◆ What is Hiragana?

Hiragana (ひらがな) is one of three Japanese writing systems. It is a **phonetic syllabary**: each character represents a single sound, not a meaning. Unlike English letters, once you learn how a hiragana character sounds, it **always** sounds the same. That makes reading beautifully predictable.



How this workbook is organised

1. The complete Hiragana chart · 2. Stroke-order guides · 3. Guided writing practice · 4. Reading exercises · 5. A mini quiz to test yourself.



How to practise well. Say each sound aloud as you write it. Follow the stroke order shown — correct order makes your writing faster and more natural. Trace the light-grey guides first, then write freely in the blank squares. Just 15 minutes a day works wonders.



A gentle goal. Aim to recognise all 46 basic characters within two weeks. Don't rush — consistency beats speed. Mikomi is with you at every step of the journey.

◆ The Five Vowels — your foundation

Every hiragana sound is built from just five vowel sounds. Learn these first:

あ

A

like "a in father"

い

I

like "ee in see"

う

U

like "oo in food"

え

E

like "e in bed"

お

O

like "o in more"

REFERENCE

The Hiragana Chart 五十音図

The gojūon ("fifty sounds") — the complete set of 46 basic hiragana. Read top to bottom, right column to left in the traditional order, or simply row by row. This is your master map.

◆ Basic Characters • 46 sounds

	A	I	U	E	O
A	あ A	い I	う U	え E	お O
K	か KA	き KI	く KU	け KE	こ KO
S	さ SA	し SHI	す SU	せ SE	そ SO
T	た TA	ち CHI	つ TSU	て TE	と TO
N	な NA	に NI	ぬ NU	ね NE	の NO
H	は HA	ひ HI	ふ FU	へ HE	ほ HO
M	ま MA	み MI	む MU	め ME	も MO
Y	や YA		ゆ YU		よ YO
R	ら RA	り RI	る RU	れ RE	ろ RO
	わ				ち

REFERENCE

Voiced & Combined Sounds 濁音・拗音

Once you know the basics, these are easy add-ons. A small " (dakuten) or ° (handakuten) mark changes the sound. Combining with small や ゆ よ makes the "yōon" blended sounds.

◆ Dakuten & Handakuten • voiced sounds

	A	I	U	E	O
G	が GA	ぎ GI	ぐ GU	げ GE	ご GO
Z	ざ ZA	じ JI	ず ZU	ぜ ZE	ぞ ZO
D	だ DA	ぢ JI	づ ZU	で DE	ど DO
B	ば BA	び BI	ぶ BU	べ BE	ぼ BO
P	ぱ PA	ぴ PI	ぷ PU	ぺ PE	ぽ PO

◆ Yōon • combined sounds

	YA	YU	YO
	きゃ KYA	きゅ KYU	きょ KYO
	しゃ SHA	しゅ SHU	しょ SHO
	ちゃ CHA	ちゅ CHU	ちょ CHO

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 1 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your hiragana look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

あ A · 3 strokes あめ (ame) rain	い I · 2 strokes いぬ (inu) dog
う U · 2 strokes うみ (umi) sea	え E · 2 strokes えき (eki) station
お O · 3 strokes おかね (okane) money	か KA · 3 strokes かさ (kasa) umbrella
き KI · 4 strokes き (ki) tree	く KU · 1 stroke くつ (kutsu) shoes
け KE · 3 strokes けさ (kesa) this morning	こ KO · 2 strokes こども (kodomo) child
さ SA · 3 strokes さかな (sakana) fish	し SHI · 1 stroke しお (shio) salt
す SU · 2 strokes すし (sushi) sushi	せ SE · 3 strokes せかい (sekai) world
そ SO · 1 stroke そら (sora) sky	た TA · 4 strokes たまご (tamago) egg

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 2 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your hiragana look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

 CHI · 2 strokes ちず (chizu) <i>map</i>	 TSU · 1 stroke つくえ (tsukue) <i>desk</i>
 TE · 1 stroke て (te) <i>hand</i>	 TO · 2 strokes とり (tori) <i>bird</i>
 NA · 4 strokes なつ (natsu) <i>summer</i>	 NI · 3 strokes にく (niku) <i>meat</i>
 NU · 2 strokes めの (nuno) <i>cloth</i>	 NE · 2 strokes ねこ (neko) <i>cat</i>
 NO · 1 stroke のみもの (nomimono) <i>drink</i>	 HA · 3 strokes はな (hana) <i>flower</i>
 HI · 1 stroke ひと (hito) <i>person</i>	 FU · 4 strokes ふね (fune) <i>boat</i>
 HE · 1 stroke へや (heya) <i>room</i>	 HO · 4 strokes ほし (hoshi) <i>star</i>
 MA · 3 strokes まど (mado) <i>window</i>	 MI · 2 strokes みみ (mimi) <i>ear</i>

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 3 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your hiragana look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

 MU · 3 strokes むし (mushi) <i>insect</i>	 ME · 2 strokes め (me) <i>eye</i>
 MO · 3 strokes もり (mori) <i>forest</i>	 YA · 3 strokes やま (yama) <i>mountain</i>
 YU · 2 strokes ゆき (yuki) <i>snow</i>	 YO · 2 strokes よる (yoru) <i>night</i>
 RA · 2 strokes らくだ (rakuda) <i>camel</i>	 RI · 2 strokes りんご (ringo) <i>apple</i>
 RU · 1 stroke るす (rusu) <i>absence</i>	 RE · 2 strokes れきし (rekishi) <i>history</i>
 RO · 1 stroke ろく (roku) <i>six</i>	 WA · 2 strokes わたし (watashi) <i>I / me</i>
 WO · 3 strokes を (wo) <i>(object particle)</i>	 N · 1 stroke ほん (hon) <i>book</i>



You now know all 46! Notice how many characters share shapes — は/ほ, ね/れ/わ, さ/き. Spotting these families makes memorising much faster. Turn the page to start writing.

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 1 (Vowels & K · S)

れんしゅう

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

あ ^A	あ	あ						
い ^I	い	い						
う ^U	う	う						
え ^E	え	え						
お ^O	お	お						
か ^{KA}	か	か						
き ^{KI}	き	き						
く ^{KU}	く	く						
け ^{KE}	け	け						
こ ^{KO}	こ	こ						
さ ^{SA}	さ	さ						

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 2 (T · N · H) れんしゅ

う

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

し SHI	し	し	し					
す SU	す	す	す					
せ SE	せ	せ	せ					
そ SO	そ	そ	そ					
た TA	た	た	た					
ち CHI	ち	ち	ち					
つ TSU	つ	つ	つ					
て TE	て	て	て					
と TO	と	と	と					
な NA	な	な	な					
に NI	に	に	に					

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 3 (M • Y • R) れんしゅ

う

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

ぬ NU	ぬ	ぬ						
ね NE	ね	ね						
の NO	の	の						
は HA	は	は						
ひ HI	ひ	ひ						
ふ FU	ふ	ふ						
へ HE	へ	へ						
ほ HO	ほ	ほ						
ま MA	ま	ま						
み MI	み	み						
む MU	む	む						
め ME	め	め						

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 4 (W • N & Review)

れんしゅう

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

も	MO	も	も					
や	YA	や	や					
ゆ	YU	ゆ	ゆ					
よ	YO	よ	よ					
ら	RA	ら	ら					
り	RI	り	り					
る	RU	る	る					
れ	RE	れ	れ					
ろ	RO	ろ	ろ					
わ	WA	わ	わ					
を	WO	を	を					
ん	N	ん	ん					

Reading Exercises よみましょう

Now put it together! Read each word aloud, sound by sound, then check the romaji and meaning. Cover the right side first and test yourself.

◆ Read these words

すし → sushi · sushi

さかな → sakana · fish

ねこ → neko · cat

いぬ → inu · dog

やま → yama · mountain

そら → sora · sky

たまご → tamago · egg

ともだち → tomodachi · friend

がっこう → gakkou · school

せんせい → sensei · teacher

にほん → nihon · Japan

ありがとう → arigatou · thank you



Great work! If you can read these, you have truly begun. Reading real words is the fastest way to lock hiragana into memory. Practise these daily until they feel effortless.

TEST YOURSELF

Mini Quiz ミニテスト

Time to check your progress! Write the romaji (English sound) for each hiragana below. No peeking — answers are at the bottom of the page.

◆ Part A • Write the romaji

1 あ

2 き

3 す

4 ね

5 は

6 も

7 ゆ

8 る

9 を

10 ん

◆ Part B • Which hiragana makes this sound?

1 KA

2 SHI

3 TSU

4 NO



おめでとう！

Congratulations on finishing!

You've taken the most important step in learning Japanese. Keep practising a little every day, and soon these characters will feel like old friends. When you're ready, your Katakana workbook is waiting — and so are we.

READY FOR THE NEXT STEP? · JOIN MIKOMI

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